

Name: _____

Date: _____

Score: _____ / 40

LEVEL A • WORKSHEET

Worksheet: The Device That Changed Everything

Comprehension + Vocabulary Tasks — based on the article on smartphones and human behaviour

PART A — COMPREHENSION TASKS [20 marks]

A1

True / False / Not Given [7 marks — 1 mark each]

Do the statements below agree with the information in the article? Write:

TRUE — if the statement agrees with the information

FALSE — if the statement contradicts the information

NOT GIVEN — if there is no information about this in the article

1. Smartphones have been widely used for over fifty years.

2. Dopamine is a brain chemical linked to motivation, reward, and pleasure.

3. Social media algorithms are designed to keep users engaged for as long as possible.

4. The presence of a phone on the table has no effect on the quality of a conversation.

5. Nomophobia refers to anxiety caused by being separated from one's smartphone.

6. All researchers agree that smartphones are harmful and should be regulated by governments.

7. The article says the most important factor is not how much you use your phone, but how deliberately you use it.

Note Completion [9 marks — 1 mark each]

Complete the notes below using **ONE WORD ONLY** from the article for each answer.

The Brain and Smartphones

8. Every notification gives the brain a small _____ hit of pleasure.

9. The unpredictability of rewards makes the dopamine response _____.

10. This is the same principle that makes _____ so difficult to stop.

Effects on Behaviour

11. Heavy smartphone users find it harder to sustain _____ for long periods.

12. Around two-thirds of people feel some level of _____ when their phone is unavailable.

13. For some users, smartphone use has become genuinely _____, meeting the criteria for addiction.

Sleep and Health

14. Screens emit a _____ light that suppresses melatonin production.

15. Poor sleep impairs cognitive function and increases the risk of _____ and depression.

16. The article describes heavy screen time and sleep disruption as a growing public _____ concern.

A3

Short Answer Questions [4 marks — 1 mark each]

*Answer these questions in your own words. Write **complete sentences**.*

17. Why does the article compare smartphone use to gambling?

18. What does the article say happens to conversation quality when a phone is on the table?

19. According to the article, what is the difference between people who feel in control of their phone use and those who do not?

20. What does the article say the goal should be — and what is it NOT?

B1**Vocabulary Matching [8 marks — 1 mark each]**

Match each word or phrase (1–8) to the correct definition (a–h).

1. dopamine	a. the fear or anxiety of being without one's smartphone	Answer: _____
2. screen time	b. a chemical in the brain linked to pleasure, motivation, and reward	Answer: _____
3. attention span	c. done regularly out of habit in a way that is difficult to control	Answer: _____
4. nomophobia	d. the length of time a person can concentrate on a task without distraction	Answer: _____
5. digital detox	e. the amount of time spent using screens such as phones, tablets, or computers	Answer: _____
6. compulsive	f. the ability to stay connected with others across distances through technology	Answer: _____
7. connectivity	g. a period of time deliberately spent away from phones and digital devices	Answer: _____
8. engagement	h. the degree to which users interact with and spend time on a platform or app	Answer: _____

B2**Gap-Fill [12 marks — 1 mark per gap]**

Complete the sentences using words from the word bank. Some sentences need more than one answer.

WORD BANK

screen time	dopamine	notification	social media
attention span	nomophobia	digital detox	multitasking
connectivity	distraction	compulsive	anxiety
productivity	mindfulness	wellbeing	addiction
app	algorithm	engagement	

9 Every _____ is a small _____ hit — a brief burst of pleasure designed by the platform's _____ to keep you coming back for more.

10 Heavy smartphone use shortens _____ because the brain becomes trained to expect constant _____ and finds it hard to wait or focus for long periods.

11 _____ describes the _____ and distress that two-thirds of people feel when their smartphone is unavailable — a figure that has grown considerably over the past decade.

12	For some users, checking their phone has become genuinely _____ — meeting many of the clinical criteria used to define _____.
13	_____ — the positive feeling of staying connected with others — is one of the genuinely good things that smartphones offer, even though the technology also comes with significant costs.
14	The article suggests that increasing _____ — tracking your patterns and being deliberate about when and how you check your phone — is one of the most effective ways to improve _____.
15	_____ platforms rely on maximising user _____ — the longer you scroll and interact, the more advertising revenue the platform generates.
16	Trying a _____ — a period deliberately spent away from your phone — can feel uncomfortable at first, but that discomfort itself reveals how much the device has changed your behaviour.
17	The goal is not to stop using your phone, but to develop a relationship with it that protects your _____ and does not allow _____ to eat into time for rest and genuine human connection.